

WILL MCGOWAN

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EDUCATION

University of Strathclyde, Glasgow

Sep 2023 – Jun 2027 (expected)

BA (Hons) Economics

- Average grade to date: 2:1, including 90% in first-year Finance
- Second-highest mark (78%) in a group project for Advanced Corporate Finance and Financial Markets
- **Relevant Modules:** Portfolio Management and Security Analysis, Applied Econometrics, Industrial Economics

Dissertation | MATLAB

In progress, due 2027

"Who Hedges the Barrel? Sovereign Oil Hedging and Petro-Currency Reactions to OPEC News"

- Testing whether sovereign oil hedges reshape a currency's reaction to OPEC news: smaller under Norway's krone conversions (vs unhedged Canada), kinked under Russia's budget rule, one-sided under Mexico's puts
- Building an original dataset of each country's rules from central bank and finance ministry records, with predictions fixed in advance and the dollar's own moves stripped out
- Testing whether what remains is tradable after costs, judged by Sharpe ratio and a White reality check

Empirical CAPM Test

MATLAB

- Tested the CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios in 54 countries (JKP global factor data) with Newey-West t-tests and the GRS joint test, rejecting it jointly in 48 of 53 countries
- Asked how many alphas luck alone would produce (about 35 of 694 at 5%) before trusting any: 123 of 215 survive a multiple-testing correction, led by momentum and value, while size looks like luck

Monte Carlo Option Pricing Engine

MATLAB

- Priced European and Asian options by simulation, benchmarked against Black-Scholes; a geometric-Asian control variate cut the arithmetic-Asian standard error by 97%, equivalent to 1,276 times as many paths

Belfast Royal Academy, Belfast

Jun 2023

- A-levels: Mathematics (A), Economics (A), Computer Science (B)

WORK EXPERIENCE

Le Set, Glasgow | Head Mixologist

Sep 2026 – Present

- Designed the 11-drink menu for a new 200-cover restaurant and cocktail lounge, including 4 original cocktails
- Wrote batch specifications for 5 pre-batched cocktails and trained around 15 staff to serve them consistently

KONG, Glasgow | Mixologist and Front of House

Oct 2024 – Jun 2026

- Analysed sales patterns to refine upselling prompts, raising average customer spend by an estimated 25%
- Trained new staff on drink specifications, POS and licensing rules; reconciled cash and card takings each shift

LEADERSHIP AND ACTIVITIES

Strathclyde Agricapital Society | Co-Founder and Treasurer

Sep 2025 – Present

- Co-founded the university's first agri-finance society (126 members); wrote weekly notes and led sessions on why buyers want each asset and what they pay, as in Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC
- Built a wheat calendar-spread strategy in R from curve structure and CFTC positioning and judged it after costs: Sharpe 0.76 before, 0.28 after, showing how quickly turnover erodes an edge

Strathclyde Poker Society | Vice-President, then President

Sep 2025 – Apr 2026

- Ran weekly tournaments for about 60 players on a £600 budget per semester, reconciling buy-ins and prizes
- Taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to estimate how many buy-ins their win rate, variance and risk level call for, with a buffer in case the edge is overestimated

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Technical: R, MATLAB, Excel, Git

Chess: 14th at the 2023 Irish U19 Championships; played 22 opponents at once (average 1860 FIDE) and won 21

Powerlifting: Northern Ireland U19 champion (2023)